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CAN INDIA BE THE VISHWAGURU?

WAR AND PEACE RESULT FROM POLITICAL CHOICES. AS THE UKRAINE WAR INCHES TOWARDS A YEAR, HERE ARE THREE POSSIBLE SCENARIOS OF ITS FUTURE COURSE

One of the critical questions of 2023 is whether the war in Ukraine will end this year. It was an avoidable war. When Leonid Kuchma was president of Ukraine from 1994 to 2004, he balanced relations with Russia and the West. Viktor Yushchenko, who succeeded him from 2005 to 2010, pushed Ukraine into the Western camp. His successor Viktor Yanukovych chose the other side of the pendulum, embracing the bear. If Ukraine had declared constitutional neutrality, Russia would not have annexed Crimea in 2014 and if Ukraine had implemented the Minsk-II agreement on Donbass, Russia would not have invaded Ukraine in 2022. Ukraine's lack of political wisdom in rejecting neutrality is not an excuse to absolve Russia of its violation of international law and the 1994 agreement guaranteeing Ukraine's sovereignty and integrity. The war in Ukraine shows that war is a matter of choice. War does not happen merely because of geography,

INDIA MUST TRY TO BRING **ABOUT A CEASEFIRE. IF SUCCESSFUL,** THIS WOULD CEMENT ITS 'VISHWAGURU' STATUS